



I MUST MAKE OF ALL THE PEOPLES OF EUROPE ONE PEOPLE, AND OF PARIS THE CAPITAL OF THE WORLD

THE BATTLE OF WATERLOO (1815)

IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

Revolutionary and Napoleonic Wars

BEFORE

1792 The Revolutionary Wars against Republican France begin.

1799 Napoleon seizes power in a military coup.

1804 Napoleon names himself Emperor of the French.

1805 The British are victorious against France and Spain in the naval Battle of Trafalgar.

1807 France invades Portugal.

1809 Austria is defeated in Napoleon's last major victory.

1814 A series of defeats lead to Napoleon's abdication.

AFTER

1815 Napoleon is exiled for the final time, and the Bourbon monarchy is restored.

1830 The Bourbon monarchy is overthrown.

Napoleon's defeat at the Battle of Waterloo, south of Brussels, on June 18, 1815, marked his final overthrow as Emperor of the French, ending 23 years of European warfare. It was an epic

France institutes **mass conscription**, creating armies of an unprecedented size.

Napoleon becomes emperor and vows to **restore France's dominant role** in Europe.

Sweeping conquests create the largest **European empire** since Charlemagne's time.

The invasion of Russia leaves **Napoleon overextended** and French manpower depleted.

The rate of Napoleonic conquest becomes **unsustainable**.

Napoleon is finally defeated at Waterloo.